

Rootless voicings: Major ii-V-I (+ V7b9)



Julian Bradley
JazzTutorial.com

Your challenge: To play the ii-V-I through all 12 keys, note-perfectly, three times in a row. If you mess up - start again!

Difficulty level = Advanced

Diagram illustrating the first system of rootless voicings for the ii-V-I progression in D minor:

Chords: Dm7, G7(b9), Cmaj7 → Cm7, F7(b9), Bbmaj7 →

Position A (Dm7, Cm7) and Position B (G7(b9)) are shown. The diagram indicates half-step movements between the chords.

PIANO

Play both hands up or down an octave as needed

Diagram illustrating the second system of rootless voicings for the ii-V-I progression in E-flat major:

Chords: Bbm7, Eb7(b9), Abmaj7 → Abm7, Db7(b9), Gbmaj7 →

Diagram illustrating the third system of rootless voicings for the ii-V-I progression in E major:

Chords: F#m7, B7(b9), Emaj7 → Em7, A7(b9), Dmaj7 →

Dm⁷ G⁷(b⁹) Cmaj⁷ (That's the first six keys)

C[♯]m⁷ F[♯]7(b⁹) Gmaj⁷ ➔

Up a half-step

Bm⁷ E⁷(b⁹) A[♯]maj⁷ ➔ **A[♯]m⁷ D⁷(b⁹) G[♯]maj⁷** ➔

Gm⁷ C⁷(b⁹) F[♯]maj⁷ ➔ **F[♯]m⁷ B[♯]7(b⁹) E[♯]maj⁷** ➔

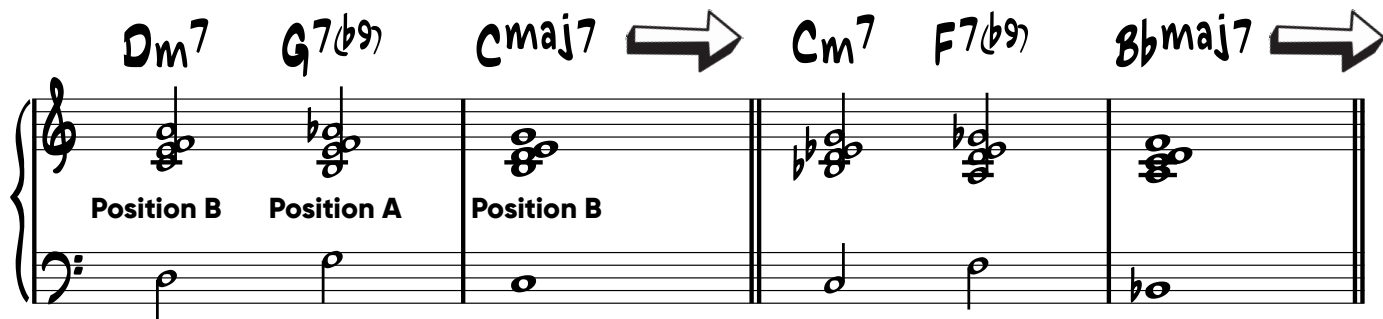
E[♯]m⁷ A[♯]7(b⁹) D[♯]maj⁷ ➔ **C[♯]m⁷ F[♯]7(b⁹) G[♯]maj⁷**

Rootless voicings: Major ii-V-I (+ V7b9)

Now do the same but switch positions. This time play position B - A - B

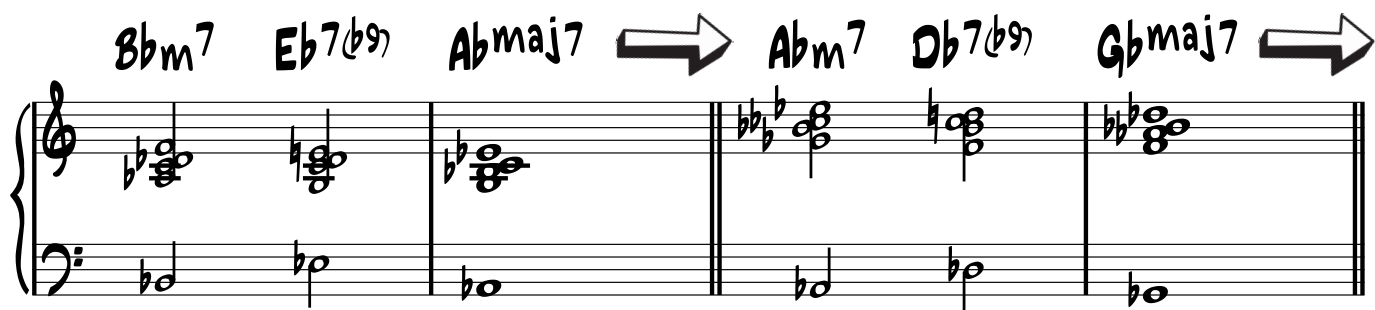
Difficulty level = Advanced

Dm⁷ G⁷(b⁹) Cmaj⁷ → Cm⁷ F⁷(b⁹) B^bmaj⁷ →

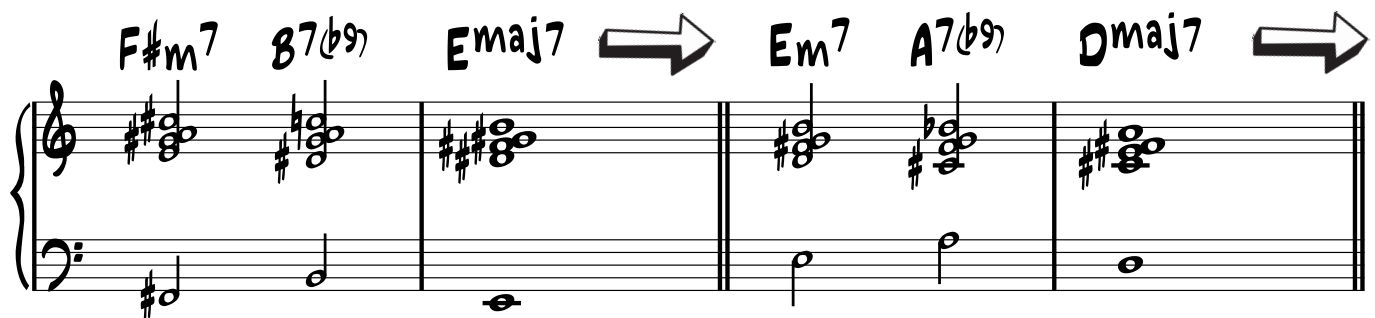


Play both hands up or down an octave as needed

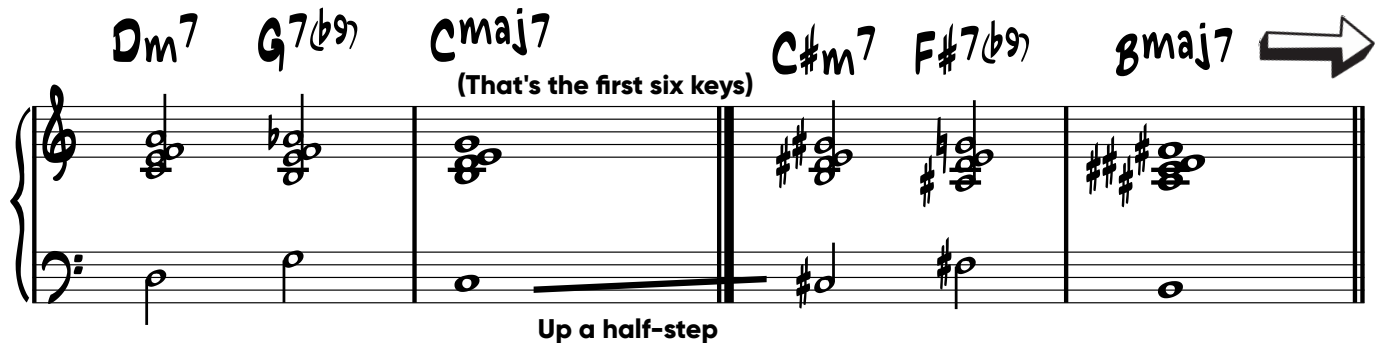
B^bm⁷ E^b7(b⁹) A^bmaj⁷ → A^bm⁷ D^b7(b⁹) G^bmaj⁷ →



F[#]m⁷ B⁷(b⁹) E⁷maj⁷ → E^m7 A⁷(b⁹) D⁷maj⁷ →



Dm⁷ G⁷(b⁹) Cmaj⁷ (That's the first six keys) C[#]m⁷ F[#]7(b⁹) G⁷maj⁷ →



Up a half-step

Bm⁷ E7(b⁹) Amaj⁷ → Am⁷ D7(b⁹) Gmaj⁷ →

Gm⁷ C7(b⁹) Fmaj⁷ → Fm⁷ Bb7(b⁹) Ebmaj⁷ →

Ebm⁷ Ab7(b⁹) Dbmaj⁷ → C#m⁷ F#7(b⁹) gmaj⁷

That's all 12 keys!

"Why is this important?"

This is a slight variation you can make to the normal rootless ii-V-I pattern. Play the V7 chord with a flat 9 - instead of a natural 9.

This voicing pattern is optional. It's quite simple to learn once you've mastered the original rootless voicing pattern through all 12 keys first.

This time you just move BOTH of the middle notes from the ii chord (5th and 7th) down a half-step.